

Invasive species are a key threat to Australia's biodiversity. They are damaging to Australia's unique ecosystems, as well as to the agriculture sector. The highest-risk exotic invasive species have been identified and compiled into the Australia's Exotic Environmental Pest List (EEPL).

The Exotic Environmental Pest List

Exotic environmental pests, diseases and weeds are those not established in Australia. If these species become established, they could cause significant damage to our environment including our unique native plants, animals and First Nations heritage sites.

In November 2020, the department released the National Priority List of Exotic Environmental Pests, Weeds and Diseases. This is also called the Exotic Environmental Pest List. The list contains 168 exotic species, categorised into 8 biological groups.

- Aquatic animal diseases
- Freshwater invertebrates
- Marine pests
- Native animal diseases (wildlife diseases)
- Plant diseases
- Terrestrial invertebrates
- Vertebrates
- Weeds and freshwater algae



Higher Risk Exotic Environmental Pests

Each biological group on the EEPL contains 17-24 entries. Each entry is either a single species, a genus, or a small set of closely related species. The 5-6 entries in each group with the highest biosecurity risk are included in a list of 42 species called the 'higher-risk EEPL'.

Complete Exotic Environmental Pest List

The National Priority List of Exotic Environmental Pests, Weeds and Diseases is listed alphabetically per thematic group. To search for a specific pest, select 'show all' before using your search function.

Common Name(s)	Species Name
*Bonamiosis	Bonamia ostreae
*Crayfish plague	Aphanomyces astaci
Grouper iridoviral disease	Singapore grouper iridovirus (SGIV) and Grouper iridovirus (GIV) (genus Ranavirus)
Infectious hematopoietic necrosis	Infectious hematopoietic necrosis virus (IHNV) (genus Rhabdovirus)
Infectious myonecrosis	Infectious myonecrosis virus (IMNV) (genus Totivirus)
Infectious pancreatic necrosis	Infectious pancreatic necrosis virus (IPNV) (genus Aquabirnavirus)
Marteiliosis (Aber disease)	Marteilia refringens
*Megalocytivirus	Infectious spleen and kidney necrosis virus (ISKNV) and Red sea bream iridovirus (RSIV) (genus Megalocytivirus)
Mikrocytosis (Denman Island disease)	Mikrocytos mackini
Necrotising hepatopancreatitis	'Candidatus Hepatobacter penaei'
Perkinsosis (Dermo disease)	Perkinsus marinus
Protozoic whirling disease	Myxobolus cerebralis / Microsporidium takedai
Taura syndrome	Taura syndrome virus (TSV) (genus Aparavirus)
Viral haemorrhagic septicaemia	Viral haemorrhagic septicaemia virus (VHSV) (genus Novirhabdovirus)
*White spot syndrome	White spot syndrome virus (WSSV) (genus Whispovirus)
Withering syndrome (of abalones)	'Candidatus Xenohalictis californiensis'
*Yellow head disease	Yellow head virus genotype-1 (YHV1) (genus Okavirus)

* indicates a higher risk species.

Common Name(s)	Species Name
*Asian clam	Corbicula fluminea
Assassin snail	Clea / Anentome spp.
Bloody-red mysid shrimp	Hemimysis anomala
Chinese mitten crab	Eriocheir sinensis
*Chinese mystery snail and Japanese mystery snail	Cipangopaludina chinensis and C. japonica

Danube crayfish / Turkish crayfish	<i>Astacus leptodactylus</i>
Freshwater mussel	<i>Cristaria plicata</i>
Freshwater snails <i>Biomphalaria</i> genus	<i>Biomphalaria</i> spp.
Freshwater snails <i>Bulinus</i> genus	<i>Bulinus</i> spp.
Freshwater snails <i>Oncomelania</i> genus	<i>Oncomelania</i> spp.
*Golden apple snail and Island apple snail	<i>Pomacea canaliculata</i> and <i>P. maculata</i>
Golden mussel	<i>Limnoperna fortunei</i>
Horn snail	<i>Indoplanorbis exustus</i>
Land snails <i>Radix</i> genus	Exotic <i>Radix</i> spp.
Louisiana red crayfish / Red swamp crayfish	<i>Procambarus clarkii</i>
Mud snail	<i>Galba truncatula</i>
Northern crayfish / Virile crayfish	<i>Orconectes virilis</i>
*Quagga mussel and Zebra mussel	<i>Dreissena bugensis</i> and <i>D. polymorpha</i>
*Quilted melania	<i>Tarebia granifera</i>
Rusty crayfish	<i>Orconectes rusticus</i>
Serrate crownsnail	<i>Pyrgophorus platyrachis</i>
Signal crayfish	<i>Pacifastacus leniusculus</i>
Spinycheek crayfish	<i>Orconectes limosus</i>

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Common Name(s)	Species Name
Asian brackish-water clam / Overbite clam	<i>Potamocorbula amurensis</i>
*Asian green mussel	<i>Perna viridis</i>
Atlantic oyster drill	<i>Urosalpinx cinerea</i>
*Black-striped false mussel	<i>Mytilopsis sallei</i>
Brown mussel	<i>Perna perna</i>
Brush-clawed shore crab	<i>Hemigrapsus takanoi</i>
*Carpet sea squirt	<i>Didemnum vexillum</i>
Centric diatom	<i>Chaetoceros concavicornis</i>
*Chinese mitten crab	<i>Eriocheir sinensis</i>
Comb jelly	<i>Mnemiopsis leidyi</i>
Harris' mud crab	<i>Rhithropanopeus harrisi</i>
Japanese shore crab	<i>Hemigrapsus sanguineus</i>
Japanese skeleton shrimp	<i>Caprella mutica</i>
Japanese wireweed	<i>Sargassum muticum</i>
*Lady crab / Asian paddle crab	<i>Charybdis japonica</i>

New Zealand green-lipped mussel	<i>Perna canaliculus</i>
Rapa whelk	<i>Rapana venosa</i>
Red-gilled mudworm	<i>Marenzelleria neglecta</i>
Soft shelled clam	<i>Mya arenaria</i>
Toxic dinoflagellate	<i>Dinophysis norvegica</i>

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Common Name(s)	Species Name
Avian paramyxovirus-3 (PMV3) and Avian paramyxovirus-5 (PMV5)	Avian paramyxovirus-3 (PMV3) and Avian paramyxovirus-5 (PMV5)
Bubonic plague	<i>Yersinia pestis</i>
Exotic novel nidovirus strains in reptiles	Exotic novel coronavirus, including python nidovirus (order Nidovirales, family Coronaviridae)
Deformed wing virus in bees	Deformed wing virus (DWV) (family Iflaviridae)
*Duck viral enteritis / duck plague	Anatid herpesvirus-1
Exotic Flaviviruses (Bagaza and Usutu)	Exotic Flaviviruses – Bagaza virus and Usutu virus
Exotic novel herpesviruses of reptiles	Family Herpesviridae, subfamily Alphaherpesvirinae
Exotic highly pathogenic avian influenza	Exotic Highly pathogenic avian influenza viruses (HPAI)
Ophidian paramyxovirus (OPMV) / Fer-de-lance virus - infection of snakes	Subfamily Paramyxovirinae, genus Ferlavirus
*Pacheco's disease and internal papillomatosis disease	Psittacid alphaherpesvirus-1 (PsHV-1)
Phocine distemper	Phocine distemper virus (PDV) (genus Morbillivirus)
*Proventricular dilatation disease	Parrot bornavirus (PaBV)
Psittacine pox virus	Psittacine pox virus (PsPoV) (genus Avipoxvirus)
Rabies virus	Rabies virus / Rabies lyssavirus (genus Lyssavirus)
Screwworm fly	<i>Chrysomya bezziana</i> and <i>Cochliomyia hominivorax</i>
Severe Perkinsea infection in frogs	Pathogenic Perkinsea clade of frogs
Snake fungal disease	<i>Ophidiomyces ophiodiicola</i>
Surra	<i>Trypanosoma evansi</i>
*West Nile virus infection	Exotic West Nile virus lineages - other than 1b (WNV Kunjin)
*White nose syndrome (of bats)	<i>Pseudogymnoascus destructans</i>

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Common Name(s)	Species Name
Annosus root and butt rot	<i>Heterobasidion annosum</i>

Armillaria root rot	Armillaria mellea
Blood disease of banana and clove wilt	Ralstonia syzygii
*Ceratocystis wilt	Ceratocystis manginecans
Ceratocystis wilt	Ceratocystis albifundus
Chestnut blight	Cryphonectria parasitica
Chrysoporthe canker / Eucalyptus canker	Chrysoporthe austroafricana
Coconut lethal yellowing	‘Candidatus phytoplasma palmae’
Dutch elm disease	Ophiostoma ulmi sensu lato
Elm yellows / Elm phloem necrosis	‘Candidatus phytoplasma ulmi’
*Fusarium wilt	Fusarium euwallaceae
Huanglongbing / Citrus greening	‘Candidatus Liberibacter asiaticus’, ‘Candidatus Liberibacter africanus’ and ‘Candidatus Liberibacter americanus’
*Myrtle rust (exotic strains)	Austropuccinia psidii – exotic strains
Oak wilt	Ceratocystis fagacearum
Phytophthora blight	Phytophthora kernoviae
*Sudden oak death / Ramorum blight	Phytophthora ramorum
Teratosphaeria canker	Teratosphaeria gauchensis
*Teratosphaeria leaf blight	Teratosphaeria destructans
Teratosphaeria stem canker	Teratosphaeria zuluensis
Texas root rot	Phymatotrichopsis omnivora
*Xylella	Xylella fastidiosa

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Terrestrial Invertebrates

Common Name(s)	Species Name
Africanised honeybee	Apis mellifera scutellata and its hybrids
Annona mealybug / Pineapple mealybug	Dysmicoccus neobrevipes
Asian / Yellow-legged hornet	Vespa velutina
Asian bee mite	Tropilaelaps clareae
Asian bee mite	Tropilaelaps mercedesae
*Asian spongy moth	Lymantria dispar (Lymantria dispar asiatica, Lymantria dispar japonica and Lymantria dispar dispar)

Brown marmorated stink bug	Halyomorpha halys
Cape honeybee	Apis mellifera capensis
Common eastern bumblebee	Bombus impatiens
Cycad aulacaspis scale	Aulacaspis yasumatsui
Delta wasp	Delta pyrifome
Dichroplus grasshopper	Dichroplus elongatus and D. maculipennis
*Electric ant	Wasmannia auropunctata
*Formosan subterranean termite	Coptotermes formosanus
*Giant African snail	Achatina fulica
Gold dust weevil	Hypomeces squamosus
*Harlequin lady beetle/ Multicolored Asian lady beetle	Harmonia axyridis
Honey bee tracheal mite	Acarapis woodi
Oriental powderpost beetle	Lyctoxylon dentatum
Picnic beetle	Glischrochilus fasciatus and G. quadrisignatus
*Red imported fire ant	Solenopsis invicta
Rosy predator snail	Euglandina rosea
Shot hole borer	Euwallacea fornicatus complex
Western drywood termite	Incisitermes minor

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Vertebrates

Common Name(s)	Species Name
African pygmy hedgehog	Atelerix albiventris
*Asian black-spined toad	Duttaphrynus melanostictus
Asian painted frog	Kaloula pulchra
*Boa constrictor	Boa constrictor
Burmese python	Python bivittatus
Chinese carp	Ctenopharyngodon idella
*Climbing perch	Anabas testudineus
Common snapping turtle	Chelydra serpentina
*Corn snake	Pantherophis guttatus
Fire bellied newt	Cynops orientalis
Flat-tailed house gecko	Hemidactylus platyurus
Green iguana	Iguana iguana
Grey squirrel	Sciurus carolinensis

House crow	<i>Corvus splendens</i>
Nile tilapia	<i>Oreochromis niloticus</i>
Oriental garden lizard	<i>Calotes versicolor</i>
Pacific rat	<i>Rattus exulans</i>
*Red-eared slider turtle	<i>Trachemys scripta elegans</i>
*Silver carp	<i>Hypophthalmichthys molitrix</i>
Snakeheads	<i>Channa</i> spp. (including <i>Channa striata</i>)
Stoat	<i>Mustela erminea</i>
Veiled chameleon	<i>Chamaeleo calyptratus</i>
Walking catfish	<i>Clarias batrachus</i>

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Common Name(s)	Species Name
Asiatic sand sedge	<i>Carex kobomugi</i>
Black sage	<i>Cordia curassavica</i>
Black swallow-wort	<i>Vincetoxicum nigrum</i>
Brittle naiad	<i>Najas minor</i>
Cane tibouchina	<i>Tibouchina herbacea</i>
*Didymo	<i>Didymosphenia geminata</i>
Halogeton	<i>Halogeton glomeratus</i>
Karoo thorn	<i>Vachellia karoo</i>
Lagariosiphon	<i>Lagarosiphon major</i>
Leafy spurge	<i>Euphorbia esula</i>
*Manchurian wildrice	<i>Zizania latifolia</i>
*Mikania	<i>Mikania micrantha</i>
*Mouse-ear hawkweed	<i>Pilosella officinarum</i>
Nepalese browntop	<i>Microstegium vimineum</i>
Portuguese broom	<i>Cytisus striatus</i>
Slangbos	<i>Seriphium plumosum</i>
South African ragwort	<i>Senecio inaequidens</i>
*Spiked pepper	<i>Piper aduncum</i>
Water primrose	<i>Ludwigia grandiflora</i>
Wiregrass	<i>Ventenata dubia</i>

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For more information

- Read the technical information about the development of [the EEPL including criteria](#)
- Contact the Environmental Biosecurity office on acebo@aff.gov.au

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/policy/environmental/priority-list>